
Report of the Town Clerk
(Continued)

Date _____
Selectboard Chair, Peru

Date _____
Selectboard Chair, Washington

Date _____
Selectboard Chair, Windsor

Date _____
School Committee Chairperson

Date _____

Commissioner of Elementary and Secondary Education

MOTION: Move that the Town approves the Central Berkshire Regional School District Amended Regional Agreement.
Select Board: Recommends
Passes unanimously.

Article #37 – ANNUAL ELECTIONS – You are also required to notify and warn the inhabitants of the Town of Becket, who are qualified to vote in Town elections, to meet at Precinct 1 in Becket Town Hall at 557 Main Street, Becket on Saturday, May 18th 2024 then and there to bring in their votes for the election of the following Town Officers:

- 1 Member, Select Board (3-year term)
- 1 Member, Board of Health (3-year term)
- 1 Cemetery Commissioner (3-year term)
- 1 Cemetery Commissioner (1-year term)
- 2 Members, Finance Committee (3-year term both)
- 1 Member, Planning Board (5-year term)
- 1 Member, Planning Board (2-year term)
- 2 Constables (3-year term both)

All of said officers and the ballot question to be voted for on the official ballots furnished at the polls. The polls will be opened at 10:00 AM and closed at 7:00 PM.

Ethan Klepetar closes out the Annual Town Meeting by reading the final article, thanks the townspeople for attending and asks for a motion to adjourn the meeting.

Moved and seconded from the floor.

Passes unanimously.

Meeting is adjourned at 5:17PM.

Respectfully submitted,

Susan A. Crossley, **Assistant Town Clerk**

Report of the Town Clerk
(Continued)

ANNUAL TOWN ELECTION, MAY 18, 2024

Pursuant to the foregoing warrant, the Town Election was held in the Becket Town Hall, 557 Main Street, on May 18th, 2024. The polling hours were 10:00 a.m. to 7:00 p.m. Prior to the polls opening, the Ballot Box was publicly opened, examined and found to be empty; the register was set at zero. The results of the election are as follows:

	<u>Votes</u>
BOARD OF HEALTH - 3 year term	
Ned Saviski	199
CEMETERY COMMISSION - 3 year term	
Michelle Smith	199
FINANCE COMMITTEE - 3 year term	
Chuck Garman	170
Ann G. Spadafora	172
PLANNING BOARD (2 positions)	
Howard Lerner - 5 year term	156
Diana Mott - 2 year term	194
SELECT BOARD - 3 year term	
William Elovirta	173
CONSTABLE (2 positions) - 3 year term	
Robert Ronzio	110
William Elovirta	174

WRITE-INS:

CEMETERY - 1 year term	Votes	FINANCE COMMITTEE - 3 year term	Votes
Hollis Giles	3	Jeremy Dunn	1
Susan Berck	2		
Bill Elovirta	1	PLANNING	Votes
Chris Felker	1	Michael Lavery	18
Sheila Keator	1		
John Murray	1	PLANNING	Votes
Anthony Pugh	1	Rita Furlong	2
		Michael Lavery	2
SELECT BOARD	Votes	CONSTABLE	Votes
Dave Johnson	9	Tom Soules	1
Bob Ronzio	2	John Polastri	3
Tommie Hutto-Blake	2	Madelaine Elovirta	2
Howard Lerner	2		

◆ **REPORT OF THE COMMUNITY PRESERVATION COMMITTEE** ◆

The Community Preservation Act is a state law that enables cities and towns to create a dedicated fund for open space, historic preservation, affordable housing, and recreation.

In 2008, the voters of Becket passed the CPA proposal for 1.5% of the annual real estate levy against real property and the town also voted to accept the following exemptions to the CPA: property owned as a domicile by any person who qualifies for low income housing, or low and moderate income senior housing; class 3 commercial, class 4 industrial, and \$100,000 of the value of each taxable parcel of residential real property.

The CPA provides a dedicated funding source for desirable and innovative projects that the community wants. The CPA also brings in state funds to include in the dedicated fund. State funding is raised through fee surcharges at the Registry of Deeds in every county in the Commonwealth and then shared with all of the communities in Massachusetts that have adopted the CPA.

This last fiscal year the voters voted to pass an article to Fund an Engineering Study for the restoration of the stone walls and pillars on Brooker Hill Road. (\$12,000.00)

The composition of the committee are as follows: (1) One member of the Conservation Commission as designated by

the Conservation Commission. (2) One member of the Historical Commission as designated by the Historical Commission. (3) One member of the Planning Board as designated by the Planning Board. (4) One member of the Parks & Recreation Committee, as designated by the Parks and Recreation Committee. (5) Three members to be appointed by the Select Board.

The Town of Becket raised \$81,922.60 for the Community Preservation Act and the State of Massachusetts donated \$13,553.00 to Becket's CPC during fiscal year 2024. These funds will eventually be used for worthy projects in our town.

We would like to thank the townspeople and the administrative staff at the Town Hall for their support of the CPA. The CPC looks forward to future project proposals.

Respectfully submitted,

Rita Furlong, **Chairman (Parks and Recreation Designee)**

John Garvey, **Clerk (Historical Commission)**

Douglas Bessone **(Conservation Committee)**

Ann Krawet **(Planning Board)**

At-large members: Mary Canty, Thomas Salzer, one vacancy



◆ **REPORT OF THE COUNCIL ON AGING** ◆

Another year has ended and we are still having fun as seniors! We always look forward to seeing each other during our regularly scheduled luncheon and bingo pursuits. In addition to our customary gatherings, we fondly remember:

- our many lunches at Papa Bob's
- ordering special take-out orders from The Becket Country Store
- celebrating William Robinson's 99th birthday
- looking for excuses to celebrate all the holidays, including our Holiday Party held at Papa Bob's. We appreciate their warm hospitality and ability to create a lovely ambiance.
- our spectacular adventure at Foxwoods. As we mentioned in last year's report, "What happens at Foxwoods stays at Foxwoods!" We most certainly know how to have a good time!

It is with great sorrow that we report the passing of our longtime friends Herbert "Sonny" Nelson (longtime Council on Aging member who had served as Treasurer and Director), Rita Bergeron (who was also my beloved sister-in-law) and Marie Grull (Council on Aging Member). We miss them dearly.

We would love to see new faces attend our events and lunches. Please join us for lunch at the Becket Town Hall, Tuesdays & Thursdays from 11AM till 2PM:

Lunch is served at 11AM on Tuesdays and Thursdays at the Becket Town Hall's Community Room on the lower level. We play Bingo following lunch. Reservations are required so that enough meals are ordered. You may sign-up to attend lunch by calling (413) 623-8934 extension 127 or you may call my mobile cell phone at (413) 281-4697. The deadline to sign-up for our Tuesday luncheon is on Friday. The deadline to sign-up for our Thursday lunch is on Monday. The cost for lunch is \$3.00 payable at the door.

We hope you can come out and join us during 2025.

Respectfully submitted,

Paula Bergeron,
On Site Director & Treasurer



◆ **REPORT OF THE CEMETERY COMMISSIONERS** ◆

Becket Center Cemetery remains in good condition with ongoing maintenance to the grounds.

Sarah Francis was appointed North Becket Cemetery Commissioner by the Select Board on 21 August 2024 to fill William Cavanaugh's remaining term, and with significant guidance from Dean Williams, things are going smoothly. She would like to thank RJ Peltier of Pioneer Plumbing & Heating for again turning the water on and off at the North Becket Cemetery. She is currently working to uncover an un-maintained area of the cemetery that contains several grave sites / monuments from the 1800s. If anyone has any information about this area, please contact Sarah at northbecketcemetery@townofbecket.org

West Becket Cemetery is in good condition. There is some tree work and brush removal that require tending. There was one lot sold this past season for a cremation burial. Going forward, requests for cremation burials will be considered and sites will be checked to see if they can be utilized.

Respectfully submitted,

Cemetery Commissioners:
Michelle Smith, ***West Becket Cemetery***
Dean Williams, ***Center Becket Cemetery***
Sarah Francis, ***North Becket Cemetery***